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GUIDE FOR SOLOPRENEURS

Selling Without Faking It

Selling as an introvert, without playing
a character you hate.

THE METHOD IN 5 MOVES

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WHAT YOU'LL FIND

5 moves to sell without playing **a role.**

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BEFORE YOU START

This guide is built to be applied this week, not studied. Keep a pen nearby: there are three short exercises along the way.

INTRODUCTION

You don't hate selling. You hate **performing**.

Two very different things, and confusing them costs you clients every month.

An introverted solopreneur often tells themselves the same story: "I'm bad at sales." But look closely at what they actually hate, and it isn't helping someone decide whether they need them. It's the character they think they have to play to get there.

That character, the one who talks loud, chases shamelessly, has an answer for everything, you're right to hate. The good news: it was never required.

THE CORE IDEA

Selling, in its honest form, is helping a person figure out whether what you do solves a problem they have. Nothing more. No spectacle. A conversation.

The five moves that follow give you that conversation, from the first sentence to the last follow-up. None of them asks you to pretend.

What underplaying really costs you.

Playing small looks careful. It's actually what costs you the most, in three zones you rarely see coming.

1

They leave without understanding

You downplay, generalize, change the subject. They leave without knowing what you do. You missed the answer, not the sale, but you take it as proof you're "bad."

2

You get paid below your value

The modesty you show to avoid bothering anyone becomes a price signal. Make yourself small about the offer, and you get made small on the invoice.

3

The character exhausts you

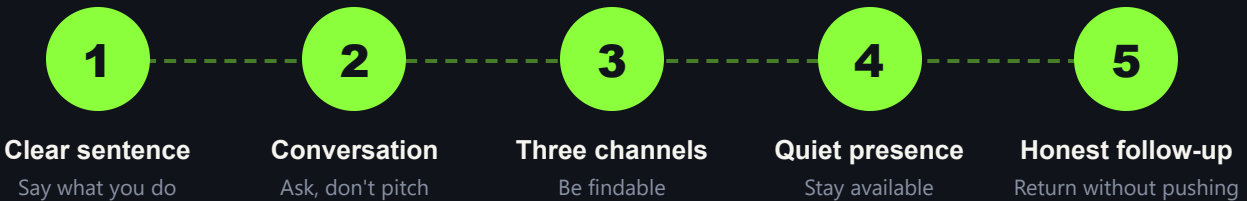
Playing a role for an hour is fine. Holding it for every client isn't. You end up avoiding chances to sell, from fatigue as much as fear.

And the tipping cost.

At some point, avoiding the sale becomes avoiding growth. You turn down chances not out of strategy, but to avoid putting on the costume. The system that follows takes the costume out of the equation: the three symptoms disappear together, because they share one cause.

Five moves. One conversation **at a time.**

None of them relies on charisma. All of them rely on clarity and listening, two things you already have.



HOW TO READ THE SYSTEM

Moves 1 and 2 play out in the conversation. Moves 3 and 4 make it happen. Move 5 recovers it when it stays open. Together, they replace the sales show with selling that fits you.

The clear **sentence**.

"So what exactly do you do?" This simple question triggers a flight reflex: please don't let this sound like a pitch. So you give three limp sentences. The fix is short: one sentence, prepared in advance.

The formula

Three pieces, in this order. That's it.

- **Who for:** the type of person you help, not "everyone."
- **What problem:** what you remove or solve for them, concretely.
- **What result:** what their life or business looks like after.

EXERCISE

Write your sentence: "I help [who for] to [result], especially when [problem]." Say it out loud three times. If it sounds like a slogan, cut a word. It should sound like you, not like an ad.

Why it works

You're not trying to impress. You're giving the other person what they need to know, in five seconds, whether they just met the right person. Seen that way, answering clearly isn't bragging. It's a service.

Three limp sentences, or **one sharp.**

The content is the same. What changes is the preparation. A sentence thought out in advance saves you from improvising at the worst moment.

THE FORMULA, PIECE BY PIECE

WHO FOR
independent
designers

+

WHAT PROBLEM
chasing a client feels
awkward

+

WHAT RESULT
getting paid on time

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE OUT LOUD

"I help independent designers get paid on time, especially when chasing a client makes them uncomfortable."

THE SHIFT

The difference between fumbling and answering sharply isn't confidence. It's having the sentence ready. You prepare it once, you reuse it a thousand times.

The conversation, not the pitch.

You've just said your clear sentence. The person roughly knows what you do, but you still don't know whether they have the problem you solve. Your reflex is to launch into a pitch. Don't.

The best salesperson for you isn't the one who talks, it's the one who asks. Your only job right now: to find out, with a few questions, whether there's a real need in front of you.

First, place the person

Two or three open questions are enough to know who you're talking to.

- And you, what do you do on your side?
- Does this resonate with you, or is it far from your world?
- Is it something you live with, or that you see around you?

If they're your person, go deeper

The problem is real for them. More targeted questions get them thinking out loud, until they want the solution themselves.

- What is this costing you right now?
- What have you already tried, and where did it stall?
- What would it look like if it were solved?

And if they're not your person, don't close the door: they very possibly know someone who is. Referrals stay one of the most overlooked sources of prospects.

Who talks, who **decides**.

Same meeting, two dynamics. The difference isn't your talent. It's who fills the space.

THE PITCH

You talk 90% of the time.

You roll out your arguments.

They nod, politely.

You don't know what they really need.

"I'll think about it."

THE CONVERSATION

They talk 70% of the time.

You ask, listen, reflect back.

They name their problem themselves.

You know exactly if you can help.

"When do we start?"

REMEMBER

"I'll think about it" isn't a rejection. It's the sound of someone who wasn't heard enough to decide. Questions fix that better than any argument.

Your three channels.

You're told to be everywhere: LinkedIn, Instagram, newsletter, networking, podcasts, YouTube. You try a bit of everything, you spread yourself across more channels than you can keep up, and you end up neglecting them all. Then you conclude you're bad at marketing. You're not bad. You're scattered.

Three, held for real

A channel only starts producing after months of steady presence. By spreading yourself thin, you never give any of them the time to reach the threshold where people recognize you. Three channels held for a year beat a long list you neglect.

Pick by temperament

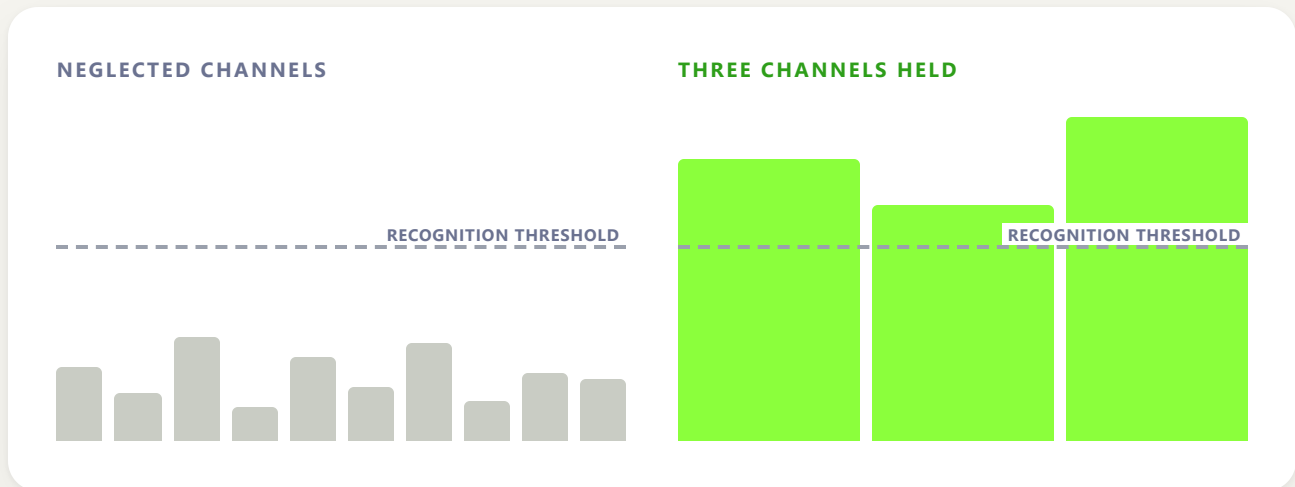
If writing calmly comes easier than talking live, a steady newsletter will do more for you than a handful of improvised stories. Align the channel with who you are, not with what the neighbor does.

EXERCISE

List the channels where you could show up. Keep the three that (a) actually reach your clients and (b) you can hold without forcing it. Focus on those, and let the rest go without guilt.

Scattered, or truly **present**.

The dashed line is the recognition threshold: the level of presence at which people remember you. Below it, you exist without existing.



THE SHIFT

It's not the amount of presence that makes you known, it's consistency. And consistency needs few channels to last.

Quiet presence.

One objection remains, and it's fair: if I don't push, nobody will come. It's true that waiting passively isn't enough. But making yourself available isn't waiting.

Between sales harassment and total silence lies a huge space. Quiet presence: saying clearly what you do, for whom, and staying reachable when the need shows up.

What it looks like

You post on your three channels at a pace you can hold. You reply when people write. You restate your offer without apologizing or insisting. You leave the door open and visible, without blocking the way.

WHAT IT CHANGES

Quiet presence doesn't take courage, it takes consistency. It's easier to hold than the big act, and far rarer. So far more noticed.

The space between the two fears.

You think you have only two options: stay silent, or become pushy. There's a third, wide, in the middle. That's where your clients are waiting.

THE SALES SPECTRUM



Total silence

They forget you. You wait for a miracle.

Quiet presence

Clear, reachable, no pressure.

Harassment

They avoid you. You burn out.

THE GOOD NEWS

The green zone is the most comfortable for you, and the most reassuring for them. You don't have to force yourself right. You just have to not stay left.

The honest follow-up.

Most sales aren't lost on a no. They're lost on silence: an "I'll think about it" nobody follows up on. The honest follow-up recovers these sales without you becoming pushy.

Three follow-ups, not thirty

A simple, spaced cadence that respects both sides:

D+2 A short note

You recap what you discussed and leave the decision open. No pressure.

D+7 One useful thing

A resource, an example, an idea tied to their problem. You give, you ask for nothing.

D+21 The door, left open

"I'm closing the file on my end, write me if the timing comes back." Honest, clean, no guilt.

REMEMBER

Following up isn't pushing. It's taking off the other person the burden of remembering you. After three follow-ups with no reply, you stop. Respecting the no is part of the method, and it's what makes you easy to recommend.

What they sold you as **a handicap.**

Your temperament gets sold to you as a commercial flaw. It's the opposite. The qualities we associate with introversion are exactly the ones that build trust.

LISTENING

You hear the real need

Not the one you wanted to sell. The client feels understood, and that's what makes them decide.

SERIOUSNESS

You don't oversell

You don't promise what you can't deliver. Your word means something, and it shows.

CALM

You apply no pressure

The absence of insistence reassures more than any pitch. People move forward with you without feeling pushed.

You don't have to become an extrovert. You have to **stop sabotaging what you already are.**

The born networker sells in a way that fits them. You'll sell in a way that fits you: one conversation at a time, depth over volume. It's not a watered-down version of selling. It's another route, just as effective.

Usable **this week.**

The method fits in three installs and one reflex. You can set it all up before Sunday, no complicated tool.

1 Your clear sentence

Written, said out loud, ready for the next time someone asks "what do you do?".

2 Your three channels

Chosen by temperament. The rest, set aside without guilt.

3 Your presence and follow-up cadence

A publishing rhythm you can hold, and the three-step follow-up (D+2, D+7, D+21).

4 The reflex: ask before you pitch

In your next conversation, ask one more question, make one fewer argument.

THE TRAP TO AVOID

Waiting for the perfect script, or to feel "ready to sell." You never will if you wait to become someone else. Start with your real voice, this week. It's the one that closes.

The method is simple. Holding it, less so.

Selling calmly rests on one thing: consistency. Your three channels held, your follow-ups done at the right moment, month after month. That's exactly what the solo mental load makes fail.

You forget to follow up. You skip a week, then two. Not from lack of will, but because your head is already full of client work. The best-designed sales plan doesn't survive one busy week.

WHAT VECTOR HOLDS FOR YOU

- Your three channels become recurring tasks that get done, not good intentions.
- Your follow-ups (D+2, D+7, D+21) are scheduled and reminded at the right time, never forgotten.
- No more "who was I supposed to get back to?": the system remembers for you.
- Your energy stays where it counts: the conversation, the one thing nobody can do for you.

The method stays yours. Vector just makes sure you hold it.

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The Foundation plan is **free for life**, no credit card. At signup you get 14 days of full Acceleration included, to try everything before you decide.

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NEXT STEP

Stop playing a role. Open the conversation.

You have the method. You can apply it this week, in your real voice. Or let Arthur hold the rhythm, while you do what you do best: help, one conversation at a time.

Try Vector free →

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